

What Changed in Gauntlet v0.6.3

Returning-player handout - release candidate · Prepared August 11, 2026 · Not published

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Status: Release candidate — not published **Baseline:** Published v0.6.2 **Release tracker:** #528

This handout explains the v0.6.3 changes that materially affect table play or how cards are read. v0.6.2 remains the published playtest edition until the v0.6.3 publication cutover is completed.

At a glance

1. **Setup now starts you on the Gauntlet.** Your token begins on the Territory at your own end; setup placement is not movement and does not count as entering.
2. **Opening selection happens before Territory arrangement.** Draw four, discard one face up, keep three, then arrange your Territories with that information known. Roll for first player last.
3. **Running the Gauntlet has two equal normal routes.** Capture the opponent's final Territory or win their Last Stand.
4. **A separate movement sequence can force a Last Stand before final-Territory capture.** Prior control of the final Territory is not required.
5. **Deck means the constructed ordinary-card set.** Draw Pile means the shuffled in-play pile. The term Playable Deck is retired in v0.6.3 player-facing text.
6. **Battle is no longer a card-effect heading.** Dual-role cards print **Gambit/Tactic**.
7. **Asset is the only banked-card heading.** The former Activate heading is retired, and cards with Asset effects normally have an inherent Bank Action.
8. **Repeated card procedures have moved into shared rules.** Cards are shorter because standard banking, directly permitted card use, effect-granted movement, additional Tactics, Sanctions, Asset Removal, Bind cleanup, reveal interference, copied/repeated effects, and battles ending without a winner are now governed centrally.
9. **Routine numeric effects use compact shorthand.** Examples include +1 Card, +1 Action, +1 Tactic, Retreat +1, Command = 2, and Advance Front Line 1.
10. **The complete 128-card pool received a production-size text audit.** All 128 v0.6.3 candidate cards pass the normal production fitter without emergency text fitting.

Setup

Prepare faction components that can modify the Deck first. Shuffle the remaining Deck to form the Draw Pile, draw four, discard one face up, and keep three. Then secretly arrange your three Territories. Form and reveal the Gauntlet, place each Player Token on the Territory at that player's own end, and roll for first player only after both players have completed opening selection and Territory arrangement.

Your opening Hand and opening discard may inform Territory order. Initiative may not.

Running the Gauntlet

You immediately run the Gauntlet and win when you either capture the Territory at your opponent's end or win your opponent's Last Stand.

A legal immediate-capture effect can win on the final Territory. After a battle forces the opponent beyond their own end, an effect that grants a separate legal movement sequence can let you Advance beyond the Gauntlet and initiate the Last Stand immediately, even if the final Territory still faces the opponent.

Reading cards

Effect headings

- **Action** — play from Hand by taking an Action at a legal phase or timing.
- **Asset** — banked-card effect; the card normally has an inherent Bank Action.
- **Gambit** — available only as a Gambit.
- **Tactic** — available only as a Tactic.
- **Gambit/Tactic** — the same effect is available in either role.

The old **Battle** and **Activate** headings are retired in v0.6.3.

Shared procedures now omitted from cards

Expect shorter text where shared rules already establish the routine procedure. This includes default Asset banking, directly permitted card procedures not costing another Action, movement granted outside an existing sequence beginning a new movement sequence, additional-Tactic handling, Sanction expiration, default Bind cleanup, reveal-stage interference, rerolls using the new result, applying/repeating another effect, and cleanup when a battle ends without a winner.

Specific exceptions remain printed on the card.

Battle habit

Before committing battle cards, check the contested Territory and your Asset Bank. This is a recommended play habit, not another battle step or timing window.

Card-text revision

The v0.6.3 card pass applies the new shared language across all 128 cards and then uses bespoke compression only where needed. **Protracted Siege** includes an expressly adopted mechanics revision: its banked Asset can directly prevent capture, while its Gambit/Tactic mode creates the delayed Overlay. Other wording changes remain governed by their finalized v0.6.3 card text and shared rules.

What remains familiar

The six factions, twelve Leaders, turn sequence, Gambit/Reserve/Tactic battle structure, Front Line concept, faction resources, and faction-specific victory systems remain based on v0.6.2 except where a v0.6.3 source expressly changes them. Specific cards and components still override general rules when they directly address the situation.